

STONE AGE CAMP

Hidden under soil for tens of thousands of years, Dolní Věstonice was once a busy camp, inhabited by about 100 Stone Age hunters. The settlement here was built around 30,000 years ago. Archaeologists excavating it have found human burials, ceramic figures, and the remains of ancient homes.

Triple burial

The skeletons of three male teenagers were discovered at Dolní Věstonice. They were buried touching each other, alongside necklaces, red ocher powder, and a mammoth bone.

The skeleton on the right was buried with its left elbow over the body in the middle.



The statuette is made of fired clay. It is 4¼ in (11 cm) tall.

Prehistoric art

Statuettes of female bodies have been found at Stone Age sites across Europe. They were carved from stone or ivory or shaped in clay. This figurine from Dolní Věstonice dates from approximately 28,000 BCE, making it one of the oldest pieces of ceramic art yet to be discovered.

Carbon dating

All living things contain carbon but, after they die, it begins to break down. Archaeologists use carbon dating to find out the age of old bones and other artifacts by measuring how much carbon is left in them.

An archaeologist takes a sample from a human leg bone.



The bear's head is held low, with its neck stretched forward.

Bear sculpture

Clay was readily available near Dolní Věstonice. People used it to make models of animals, such as this bear. Once sculpted, the models were baked in campfires to make them harden and keep their shape.



Stone Age sites

Dolní Věstonice is in the Pavlov Hills near the city of Brno in the South Moravian area of the Czech Republic. It is not the only discovery of its kind, several other Stone Age sites have been found in the vicinity of Dolní Věstonice.